

Yifei Zhao

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Education

University of Central Florida, Orlando, FL

Aug 2024 – Present

Ph.D. in Computer Science

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Technical Skills

Agent Frameworks: NVIDIA NeMo Agent Toolkit, AWS Strands Agents SDK, LangChain, AutoGen, CrewAI

Agentic Systems: SWE-agent, multi-agent orchestration, LLM routing, sandboxed execution, MCP, RAG

ML Systems: PyTorch, vLLM, llama.cpp

Projects

MarkAgentX: Unified IP Protection Toolkit for LLM Agents

2026

- Building framework-agnostic agent trajectory watermarking for long-horizon multi-agent systems.

AIDE-FHE: Autonomous Fully Homomorphic Encryption Challenge Solver

2026

- Built an FHE coding-agent [evaluation pipeline](#) and a tree-search agent with execution-guided refinement.

SafeRouter: Security-Aware Routing for Multi-LLM Systems

2026

- Built a joint model-and-defense router for safer, lower-cost multi-LLM inference.

Research Publications

REALM: A Unified Red-Teaming Benchmark for Physical-World VLMs

2026 · Preprint

Yifei Zhao, Qian Lou, Mengxin Zheng

- Built a unified physical-world VLM red-teaming benchmark with agent-generated attack objectives.

SIF: Semantically In-Distribution Fingerprints for Large Vision-Language Models

2026 · CVPR

Yifei Zhao, Qian Lou, Mengxin Zheng

- Developed the first stealthy, robust in-distribution fingerprints for LVLM ownership.

AttestLLM: Efficient Attestation Framework for Billion-scale On-device LLMs

2026 · DAC

Ruisi Zhang, Yifei Zhao*, Neusha Javidnia, Mengxin Zheng, Farinaz Koushanfar*

- Built the first TEE-based framework to verify billion-parameter on-device LLM integrity.

Experience

University of Central Florida

Aug 2025 – Present

Teaching Assistant – COP3402: System Software

- Mentored 130+ students in C systems programming and compiler fundamentals.

Honors and Awards

- ORCGS Doctoral Fellowship, University of Central Florida, 2024